

7 CONTENT MANAGEMENT SYSTEM

If you've avoided using WordPress as a solution for building your own web site because you think it's only a blogging platform, and you don't want to have a blog (not every web site owner does, after all), it's time to rethink your position. WordPress is an able Content Management System (CMS) that is flexible and extensible enough to run an entire Web site — with no blog at all, if you prefer.

A CMS lets you maintain your web site with little or no knowledge of HTML. You can create, modify, retrieve, and update your content without ever having to touch the code required to perform those tasks. CMS programs such as WordPress give you the tools and advantages of blog software for managing and maintaining your site. These programs make setting up a web site much easier than in the past. Before, if you didn't know HTML, you had to hire a webmaster to maintain your web site. With WordPress, you can do all that yourself, with or without HTML knowledge. That capability translates into a huge cost savings and opens the door to anyone who wants to run a web site but doesn't have the resources or knowledge to do it.

This chapter shows you a few ways that you can use the self-hosted WordPress.org software to power your entire web site, with or without a blog. It covers different template configurations that you can use to create separate sections of your site. You also discover how to use the front page of your site as a landing page (a static page) or portal (a page that contains snippets from other sections of your site, with links to those sections), which can include a link to an internal blog page, if you want a blog.

7.1 Creating the static page

By default, a WordPress home page shows chronological blog post entries with the most recent post at the top. If your goal is to have a WP-created Page with static information, WordPress will allow you to select a different page as your home page so that you can display more traditional content like information about yourself or your business.

In your admin area, just go to **Setting > Reading**. Here you can decide if your home page will display your blog posts or a static page, if you choose a static page you can also choose which page to be your home page from the select box.